TEACHER BOOK - EPIC CAMPUS GENERAL ENGLISH

The 12 tenses

Teacher book: teach one tense at a time, with the students writing

How to use this book

1. Teach **one tense a day**. Give the student tute for that tense.
2. Fill in the table **together**: say the formula, write the first example, then ask the students for more.
3. Students write their own examples on the blank lines.
4. Do the tute activity: A on the board together, B alone, C by discussion.
5. Correct the tense kindly and straight away.

The order

Present	Past	Future
1. Present simple	5. Past simple	9. Future simple
2. Present continuous	6. Past continuous	10. Future continuous
3. Present perfect	7. Past perfect	11. Future perfect
4. Present perfect continuous	8. Past perfect continuous	12. Future perfect continuous

> Page 14 is the summary activity for all 12 tenses. Page 15 is a one-page chart of every formula.

1. Present simple

Tense 1 of 12

WE USE IT FOR

Habits, routines and facts.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

every day, always, usually, often, never, on Mondays

	Formula and one example	More examples (students write)
Affirmative	**S + V1 (add -s / -es after he, she, it)** **She studies English every day.**	
Negative	**S + do not / does not + V1** **She does not study Korean on Sunday.**	
Active	**S + V1 + object** **The teacher checks the papers.**	
Passive	**am / is / are + V3** **The papers are checked by the teacher.**	

Teacher advice

- Stress the -s after he, she, it. Common mistakes: "he go", "she don't like". Do/does is only for the negative and the question; the verb goes back to V1.
- Do the activity: A together, B alone, C by discussion.

2. Present continuous

Tense 2 of 12

WE USE IT FOR

Happening now or around now; temporary things; fixed plans for the near future.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

now, right now, at the moment, today, Look!, Listen!

	Formula and one example	More examples (students write)
Affirmative	**S + am / is / are + V-ing** **She is reading a book.**	
Negative	**S + am / is / are + not + V-ing** **She is not reading a book.**	
Active	**S + am / is / are + V-ing + object** **The teacher is checking the papers.**	
Passive	**am / is / are + being + V3** **The papers are being checked.**	

Teacher advice

- Do the spelling of -ing: write → writing, run → running, make → making. Do not use it with state verbs (know, like, want): "I know", not "I am knowing".
- Do the activity: A together, B alone, C by discussion.

3. Present perfect

Tense 3 of 12

WE USE IT FOR

A past action with a result now; life experience; things that started in the past and continue (for / since).

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

already, yet, just, ever, never, since, for, so far

	Formula and one example	More examples (students write)
Affirmative	**S + have / has + V3** **She has finished her homework.**	
Negative	**S + have / has + not + V3** **She has not finished her homework.**	
Active	**S + have / has + V3 + object** **The teacher has checked the papers.**	
Passive	**have / has + been + V3** **The papers have been checked.**	

Teacher advice

- Use V3 (the list from the verb forms tute). Do not use it with a finished time word: "I have seen him yesterday" is wrong; say "I saw him yesterday".
- Do the activity: A together, B alone, C by discussion.

4. Present perfect continuous

Tense 4 of 12

WE USE IT FOR

An action that started in the past and is still going on, or has just stopped; it stresses how long.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

for, since, all day, how long, lately, recently

	Formula and one example	More examples (students write)
Affirmative	**S + have / has + been + V-ing** **She has been studying for two hours.**	
Negative	**S + have / has + not + been + V-ing** **She has not been studying.**	
Active	**S + have / has + been + V-ing + object** **The teacher has been checking papers all day.**	
Passive	**Rarely used in English.** **Use instead: The papers have been checked.**	

Teacher advice

- The passive of this tense is almost never used. Tell students to use the present perfect passive instead (The papers have been checked). Compare with present perfect: "I have read the book" (finished) and "I have been reading" (still going or just stopped).
- Do the activity: A together, B alone, C by discussion.

5. Past simple

Tense 5 of 12

WE USE IT FOR

A finished action at a known time in the past.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

yesterday, last week, ago, in 2020, when I was young

	Formula and one example	More examples (students write)
Affirmative	**S + V2 (regular: +ed)** **She studied last night.**	
Negative	**S + did not + V1** **She did not study last night.**	
Active	**S + V2 + object** **The teacher checked the papers.**	
Passive	**was / were + V3** **The papers were checked by the teacher.**	

Teacher advice

- After "did" the verb is V1: "did not go", not "did not went". Revise the V2 column of the verb forms list.
- Do the activity: A together, B alone, C by discussion.

6. Past continuous

Tense 6 of 12

WE USE IT FOR

An action in progress at a moment in the past; a longer action interrupted by a shorter one.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

while, when, at 8 o'clock yesterday, all evening

	Formula and one example	More examples (students write)
Affirmative	**S + was / were + V-ing** **She was studying at eight.**	
Negative	**S + was / were + not + V-ing** **She was not studying at eight.**	
Active	**S + was / were + V-ing + object** **The teacher was checking the papers.**	
Passive	**was / were + being + V3** **The papers were being checked.**	

Teacher advice

- Draw a time line: the long action is a wavy line, the short action cuts across it. "While" goes with the long action, "when" with the short one.
- Do the activity: A together, B alone, C by discussion.

7. Past perfect

Tense 7 of 12

WE USE IT FOR

The earlier of two past actions.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

before, after, already, by the time, when

	Formula and one example	More examples (students write)
Affirmative	**S + had + V3** **She had left before I arrived.**	
Negative	**S + had not + V3** **She had not left before I arrived.**	
Active	**S + had + V3 + object** **The teacher had checked the papers.**	
Passive	**had + been + V3** **The papers had been checked.**	

Teacher advice

- Draw two events on a line: the earlier one is past perfect, the later one is past simple. "Had" is the same for every subject.
- Do the activity: A together, B alone, C by discussion.

8. Past perfect continuous

Tense 8 of 12

WE USE IT FOR

An action that had been going on for some time before another moment in the past.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

for, since, how long, before, when

	Formula and one example	More examples (students write)
Affirmative	**S + had + been + V-ing** **She had been studying for two hours.**	
Negative	**S + had not + been + V-ing** **She had not been studying.**	
Active	**S + had + been + V-ing + object** **The teacher had been checking papers for hours.**	
Passive	**Rarely used in English.** **Use instead: The papers had been checked.**	

Teacher advice

- The passive is almost never used. Use the past perfect passive instead (The papers had been checked). Compare: "had waited" (finished) and "had been waiting" (stresses how long).
- Do the activity: A together, B alone, C by discussion.

9. Future simple

Tense 9 of 12

WE USE IT FOR

Decisions made now, predictions and promises.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

tomorrow, next week, soon, I think, probably

	Formula and one example	More examples (students write)
Affirmative	**S + will + V1** **She will call you tomorrow.**	
Negative	**S + will not (won't) + V1** **She will not call you tomorrow.**	
Active	**S + will + V1 + object** **The teacher will check the papers.**	
Passive	**will + be + V3** **The papers will be checked.**	

Teacher advice

- "Will" is the same for every subject and is followed by V1 (never "will goes"). "Going to" is the plan form; keep it for later.
- Do the activity: A together, B alone, C by discussion.

10. Future continuous

Tense 10 of 12

WE USE IT FOR

An action that will be in progress at a moment in the future.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

this time tomorrow, at 8 o'clock tonight, next week

	Formula and one example	More examples (students write)
Affirmative	**S + will + be + V-ing** **She will be studying at eight.**	
Negative	**S + will not + be + V-ing** **She will not be studying at eight.**	
Active	**S + will + be + V-ing + object** **The teacher will be checking the papers.**	
Passive	**Rarely used in English.** **Use instead: The papers will be checked.**	

Teacher advice

- The passive is very rare and sounds heavy ("will be being checked"). Use the future simple passive instead (The papers will be checked).
- Do the activity: A together, B alone, C by discussion.

11. Future perfect

Tense 11 of 12

WE USE IT FOR

An action that will be finished before a moment in the future.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

by, by the time, by next year, before

	Formula and one example	More examples (students write)
Affirmative	**S + will + have + V3** **She will have finished by June.**	
Negative	**S + will not + have + V3** **She will not have finished by June.**	
Active	**S + will + have + V3 + object** **The teacher will have checked the papers.**	
Passive	**will + have + been + V3** **The papers will have been checked.**	

Teacher advice

- The key word is "by". Draw the future deadline on a line and mark the action finished before it.
- Do the activity: A together, B alone, C by discussion.

12. Future perfect continuous

Tense 12 of 12

WE USE IT FOR

How long an action will have been going on up to a moment in the future.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

by, for, by next month, by the time

	Formula and one example	More examples (students write)
Affirmative	**S + will + have + been + V-ing** **She will have been studying for six hours.**	
Negative	**S + will not + have + been + V-ing** **She will not have been studying for long.**	
Active	**S + will + have + been + V-ing + object** **The teacher will have been checking papers for six hours.**	
Passive	**Rarely used in English.** **Use instead: The papers will have been checked.**	

Teacher advice

- This is the rarest tense. Teach it last, keep it short, and do not use a passive (use the future perfect passive: The papers will have been checked).
- Do the activity: A together, B alone, C by discussion.

TEACHER BOOK - SUMMARY

All 12 tenses: summary

Mixed practice: affirmative, negative, active and passive

Step 1. Name the tense (do together)

> Example 1: **The letter was written by Nimal.** Past simple, passive.
> Example 2: **They have not finished.** Present perfect, negative.

STUDENTS WRITE MORE SENTENCES AND NAME THEM

Step 2. Change the sentence (do together)

> Example: **The cook has made the food.** to the passive: The food has been made by the cook.

STUDENTS TRY THEIR OWN

Step 3. Practical task (group)

> Each student tells the group what they did yesterday, what they are doing now and what they will do tomorrow. The group names each tense.

TEACHER BOOK - QUICK REFERENCE

Chart: all 12 tenses

Formulas for the teacher and for the board

	Simple	Continuous	Perfect	Perfect continuous
Present	V1 (+s / es)	am / is / are + V-ing	have / has + V3	have / has been + V-ing
Past	V2	was / were + V-ing	had + V3	had been + V-ing
Future	will + V1	will be + V-ing	will have + V3	will have been + V-ing

Passive voice

Tense	Passive formula
Present simple	am / is / are + V3
Present continuous	am / is / are + being + V3
Present perfect	have / has + been + V3
Past simple	was / were + V3
Past continuous	was / were + being + V3
Past perfect	had + been + V3
Future simple	will + be + V3
Future perfect	will + have + been + V3

> The four perfect continuous and future continuous passives are almost never used. Use the simple passive instead.